

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at EY,

I trained as an architect, and what kept me was the question that comes before the drawings, what an asset is actually worth and whether the reasoning behind that number holds. Alongside architecture I kept a second interest running, data, and I moved from Brazil to Copenhagen for an M.Arch in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy to put the two together. A pricing team inside FAAS is where that points now, because the work is less about producing a number than about judging whether someone else's model deserves to be believed.

The clearest version of that in my own work is a property valuation model I built using ensemble methods (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Ridge) on structured property and financial data, which finished in the top two percent of a competitive field. Most of the work was feature engineering, deciding which property and financial attributes actually carried signal, because a model will return a price whether or not the inputs justify one. Building a valuation from the inside is what teaches you which assumptions in someone else's are load-bearing.

Earlier, as a trainee in real estate product development at OSPA, I produced more than fifteen feasibility studies across São Paulo, Rio de Janeiro, Porto Alegre and Miami, sizing investment and return against buildable area, unit mix and price per square metre, then presenting those assumptions to developers who had their own reading of the market. I also build the tooling around this kind of analysis. For a private client I wrote an Excel and VBA tool that ingests monthly statements and PDF exports, categorises transactions automatically and renders them into a decision dashboard, and at Ramboll I built an automated risk-assessment system in Excel that consolidated supply chain data into a single view that updated as the inputs changed.

Real estate is one of the asset classes your team prices, and it is the one I already know from the inside, having assessed buildings Itaú-Unibanco was acquiring or leasing. Private equity and private debt are where I want to learn the rest.

All the best,

Antonio Carmagnani